

Deep Dive: The Three Types of Confidence

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OK, so we've talked a little about affirmations and self-talk and the role they play. Now let's talk a little about the three types of confidence.

Knowing about the three types of confidence is important in progressing through your career and having belief in yourself.

The first is *false confidence*. This is being confident you can do something with no evidence to back it up. You might call this "fake it till you make it," and you just sort of hope it works out. Maybe you know some people in your own life who are notorious for false confidence – they are convinced things will work out, or they can deliver, but with little to base those claims on! Some people stay in this phase for a long time, but these are the "talkers," not the "doers" of the world.

False confidence isn't *all* bad. The truth is, sometimes you need a little false confidence to get yourself started when you're tackling something new. You may be in a new field or a new industry, maybe you've taken on a new promotion and you're doing something you've never done before. You have no clue what you're doing. What you want to do in this phase is lean on your self-talk and confidence anchors to get you through. These are areas where you have succeeded in the past, and you're leaning on the confidence from that anchor and applying it to a new area.

Let's say you've run a marathon before, but your spouse wants you to train to go rock climbing with them and you've never climbed anything before. Or maybe you're used to leading a large marketing team, but you have a new role in TV and film where you're now managing a production crew. It's easy to feel a little intimidated when you have to do something you haven't done before, but the proper self-talk can get you through this phase as quickly as possible. You don't want to hang out in this phase for long.

I remember when I was first starting out as a speaker and trainer, and I remember I had no clue what I was doing. I was so, so nervous, sweating, you know one of those things. And I just remember putting myself in the shoes of my leader for that one hour. I was not Christina, I was Dave, and I put on the mask and I put on the face, and I just went out there and I just went out there and faked it and it ended up being OK, but I was very, very conscious in making sure I got through that phase really well.

So, the next kind of confidence is *conditional confidence*. Conditional confidence is attaching your confidence to results. This is a trap most women fall into. It's the ups and

downs of confidence. If you have a big day or a big month then your confidence is high. If you have a bad week or bad month in terms of your career or results, your confidence is low.

If you just crushed a major project or got a big promotion, you're feeling great. If you're having difficulty with a co-worker or you just got passed over for a role you really wanted, your confidence takes a nose-dive. Or, if things are going well at home, you feel like a rockstar, as a mom you're crushing it! If you find things getting out of balance, you're a "bad mom," what am I doing?

Sound familiar? Conditional confidence causes a lot of stress and can cause you to question everything.

You want to move as quickly as you can from conditional confidence to the third type of confidence, unconditional confidence.

Unconditional confidence is where we all want to get to. Your confidence isn't based on whether or not you're doing a good job or what's happening in the moment. Unconditional confidence is based on your habits and the things you can control. You can't control results sometimes – whether or not you get promoted, whether or not you're picked to be on a certain work committee or land that big account – but you CAN control your effort, your attitude and, to a certain degree, your skillset.

This is the type of confidence that we want to strive to have most consistently. Because unconditional confidence takes you to the next level.

So, take a minute to think about where you are in your life today. Are you operating in false confidence, conditional confidence or unconditional confidence? And it may not be one zone – it may look different for different parts of your life, right?

But now that you know what to do, go out and make today a great one, one where you can be your BEST, most confident self.